

Terms of Reference (ToR) for the procurement of IT services

CONFIDENTIAL

Project title: ProSME	Processing number/cost centre: G-011950-001
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Works/services to be put out to tender:	
	Transaction number:

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0. Abbreviations

API	Application programming interface
BMF	Federal Ministry of Finance
CV	Curriculum vitae
ERD	Entity relationship diagram
EVB-IT	Supplementary Terms and Conditions for the Procurement of IT Services
GIZ	Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) GmbH
GWB	German Competition Act
OSS	Open source software
SaaS	Software-as-a-service
ToR	Terms of Reference
VgV	German Ordinance on the Award of Public Contracts

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1. Context

1.1 The company

The Deutsche Gesellschaft für Internationale Zusammenarbeit (GIZ) GmbH supports the German Federal Government in achieving its objectives in the field of international cooperation for sustainable development and international education. The company is active in several fields: economic development and employment; governance and democracy; peacebuilding, security, reconstruction and civil conflict transformation; food and nutrition security, health, basic education, environmental protection, resource conservation and climate change mitigation.

GIZ operates in some 120 countries worldwide and second experts and managers to projects and programmes. A high percentage of these partner countries are marked by fragile statehood, violence and risks for individual safety and security. GIZ is responsible not only for its own staff members but also for the safety and security of partners, consultants and other involved parties.

1.2 Project background

The ProSME Fund Project (Promotion of SME Development in Namibia) is a flagship national economic instrument established to provide targeted, inclusive financial and technical support to ambitious Namibian micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) operating across all sectors of the economy. At its core, ProSME aims to enhance the competitiveness, sustainability, and export capacity of Namibian MSMEs by providing structured funding tools, including grants, concessional loans, matching funds, and blended finance mechanisms tailored to each enterprise's development stage and growth path. The programme also acts as a catalytic vehicle to attract additional private and development capital over time, leveraging public investment to unlock larger pools of risk capital, development finance, and institutional co-investment. In doing so, it directly supports the broader goals of Vision 2030, Harambee Prosperity Plan III, and Namibia's National Development Plans.

To support these objectives, ProSME needs a professional, high-performance public-facing website that acts as the main digital interface between the programme and its stakeholders. The website must clearly communicate the programme's mandate, offer accessible information on funding calls and eligibility, enable seamless online applications, and encourage active engagement within the national MSME community. (use the project factsheet background, incorporate the objective and approach)

The ProSME project works with NIPDB to optimise existing funding programmes and initiate new ones. These help Namibian MSMEs to improve their competitiveness over the long term. The project focuses on two main areas. One is to establish an MSME fund in cooperation with NIPDB. This will enable the provision of needs-based, gender-sensitive financial support from NIPDB for MSMEs with growth potential. The project also assists with tender procedures for the funding programmes. In parallel, the project advises NIPDB on expanding existing MSME funding programmes as well as developing new programmes and integrating them sustainably into NIPDB's structures.

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1.3 Objective of the commission/subject of the procurement

ProSME requires the procurement of professional IT services for the design, development, and deployment of a comprehensive, secure, and user-friendly website for the SME Fund. The website will serve as the primary public interface for the programme and support engagement with Namibian micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) and other stakeholders

The services to be delivered include:

- Design and development of a fully functional, mobile-responsive website
- Development of an integrated online application system with workflow management capabilities
- Integration of third-party tools, including an AI-powered chatbot
- Configuration of a content management system (CMS) for internal use
- Implementation of data analytics, reporting, and user tracking functionalities
- Testing, deployment, and handover of the complete solution
- Training of SME Fund staff and provision of post-launch support

2. Requirements for the IT solution

The service provider shall deliver a comprehensive, secure, and scalable IT solution in the form of a public-facing website with integrated application and workflow management functionalities for the SME Fund Programme.

The requirements for the IT solution are outlined below

Scope of Work

The selected service provider shall be responsible for the complete lifecycle of the website, encompassing discovery and planning, design, development, testing, deployment, training, and post-launch support. The scope covers the following work streams: stakeholder consultation and requirements validation; UX and UI design; front-end and back-end development; CMS configuration and content population; integration of third-party tools and APIs; quality assurance, security testing, and performance optimisation; staff training and knowledge transfer; and full handover of all source code, assets, credentials, and intellectual property.

Technical and Design Requirements

Website Design

The website shall reflect the professional, credible, and inclusive character of the SME Fund, balancing accessibility and approachability for MSME entrepreneurs across Namibia. It shall feature a modern, clean visual identity aligned with SME Fund branding guidelines and be fully responsive across mobile, tablet, and desktop devices. Design must be optimised for low-bandwidth environments reflective of Namibia's connectivity landscape. A minimum of three distinct design concepts shall be submitted for client selection, maintaining consistent typography, iconography, and colour palette throughout.

Core Website Pages and Structure

The website shall include, at a minimum, the following pages and sections:

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- **Home** - Programme overview, featured calls, news highlights, and call-to-action elements
- **About** - Background, mandate, objectives, governance structure, and team
- **Funding Instruments** - Detailed descriptions of each funding type with eligibility summaries
- **Funding Calls** - Active, upcoming, and closed calls with filtering by sector, region, and funding type
- **Eligibility Checker** - Interactive self-assessment tool guiding applicants through qualification criteria
- **How to Apply** - Step-by-step application guidance, FAQs, and downloadable guides
- **Online Application Portal** - Secure, multi-step application forms with workflow management and document upload
- **News & Media** - Programme updates, press releases, success stories, and multimedia gallery
- **Resources** - Downloadable toolkits, templates, MSME development guides, and recorded webinars
- **Events Calendar** - Upcoming information sessions, workshops, and roadshows
- **Contact Us** - Contact form, office location map, and stakeholder directory
- **Applicant Dashboard** - Logged-in portal for tracking application status and uploading documents

Any additional pages deemed necessary may be identified during discovery workshops with the client.

Content Management System

The website shall be built on WordPress, Drupal, or a comparable CMS, with an intuitive interface enabling non-technical staff to create, edit, and publish content independently. The system shall support role-based access control across Administrator, Editor, Author, and Reviewer roles, and maintain a full audit trail and version history for all content changes.

Technical Specifications

The website shall have HTTPS enabled across all pages via an SSL/TLS certificate, adhere to current web security best practices, and maintain cross-browser compatibility across Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge, and mobile browsers. Structured data mark-up (Schema.org) shall be implemented to enhance search engine visibility.

Functional Requirements

Funding Calls Management

The website shall provide a dynamic, searchable directory of funding calls, enabling administrators to publish and manage open, upcoming, and closed calls with configurable open and close dates. Users shall be able to filter and search by funding type, target sector, enterprise development stage, and geographic region. Each call shall display specific eligibility criteria, funding limits, required documentation, and application deadlines. Call status shall update automatically based on system date, and optional email notifications may be configured to alert registered users when new calls are published.

Eligibility Checker

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An interactive eligibility self-assessment tool shall be embedded within the Funding Calls section. The tool shall guide prospective applicants through a question-based interface with dynamic branching logic based on user responses including enterprise type, turnover, employment size, and sector and shall produce a clear eligible, ineligible, or conditional result with explanation and recommended next steps. Data captured from assessments shall be logged anonymously for analytics purposes.

Online Application System and Workflow Engine

This represents a critical functional requirement. The system shall enable end-to-end online application submission and management.

From the applicant's perspective, the system shall provide a multi-step, form-based interface with a progress indicator and save-and-resume functionality, secure document upload, real-time form validation with contextual help text, an application summary and declaration prior to final submission, and an automated confirmation email with a unique reference number. Applicants shall also have access to a personal dashboard through which they can monitor submission status, respond to reviewer queries, and upload additional documentation.

Internally, the system shall support a configurable multi-stage review workflow spanning submission, screening, assessment, approval committee, and outcome stages. Role-based task assignment shall be available for programme officers, sector specialists, and approval panel members. The system shall capture reviewer comments, scoring rubrics, and recommendations, and shall trigger automated email notifications to applicants at each workflow stage transition. Administrators shall have access to bulk status update tools, batch communication functionality, and the ability to export application data to Excel or CSV for offline review and reporting. Integration hooks shall be provided for future connection to financial management or ERP systems.

AI-Powered Chatbot and Smart Assistance

An AI-powered chatbot shall be integrated into the website, available around the clock to assist visitors and applicants. The chatbot shall be trained on SME Fund content including eligibility criteria, funding instruments, application processes, and FAQs and shall be capable of responding to queries in plain English. An escalation pathway shall enable seamless handoff to a human operator or logging of unresolved queries for follow-up. Monthly chatbot interaction analytics shall be reported to administrators.

Communication and Notification Engine

The system shall support automated transactional emails triggered by application events, including submission confirmations, review requests, and outcome notifications. Newsletter subscription management shall also be available for registered users and interested stakeholders.

Visitor Analytics and Reporting

The website shall integrate with Google Analytics and provide a custom dashboard for SME Fund administrators tracking page views, session duration, user journeys, call engagement, application funnel metrics, and geographic distribution of users. Automated bi-weekly and monthly analytical reports shall be delivered by email to designated administrators. Heatmap and click-tracking integration shall be included to support ongoing UX optimisation.

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Interactive Data Visualisations and Programme Statistics

A public-facing dashboard shall display key SME Fund statistics, including total applications received, funding disbursed, sectors supported, jobs created, and geographic reach. Data shall be presented through interactive maps, charts, graphs, and infographics that update dynamically from the CMS. Administrators shall be able to update statistics, upload new visualisations, and manage dashboard content without developer intervention, and shall be able to export charts and statistics for use in reports and presentations.

Events and Information Sessions

An integrated events calendar shall list SME Fund roadshows, applicant information sessions, and stakeholder forums. Online event registration shall be supported, with automated confirmation and reminder emails. A searchable and filterable repository of past webinar recordings and virtual information session content shall also be maintained.

Resource Centre

A centralised resource repository shall host SME Fund publications, application guides, business development toolkits, and templates, searchable and filterable by category, funding instrument, and enterprise development stage. Certain resources may be gated for registered applicants only. The Resource Centre shall also feature MSME success stories and case studies with multimedia support, including images and video.

User Registration and Applicant Portal

Self-registration shall be available to Namibian MSME applicants and interested stakeholders. The system shall provide secure login with password reset functionality and optional two-factor authentication. Users shall be able to manage their profiles including enterprise details, contact information, and a personal document library and access a personalised dashboard featuring saved eligibility assessments, active and historical applications, notifications, and saved resources

Deliverables

The selected service provider shall be required to produce and submit the following deliverables over the course of the engagement:

- **Project Inception Report and Validated Requirements** - To be submitted within five business days of contract signing, confirming the agreed scope, timeline, and technical approach.
- **Three Website Design Concepts** - Comprising wireframes and visual mock-ups across three distinct design directions, submitted for client selection and feedback.
- **Approved Final Design Prototype** - The refined and fully detailed prototype of the preferred concept, produced following formal client sign-off.
- **Fully Developed and Operational Website** - The complete, live website incorporating all functional requirements as specified in the Technical and Functional Requirements sections of this Terms of Reference.

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- **AI Chatbot Trained and Deployed** - A fully operational AI-powered chatbot with a programme-specific knowledge base, integrated into the live website.
- **Online Application System with Workflow Engine** - The end-to-end application submission and review system, fully tested using dummy applications prior to launch.
- **Analytics Dashboard Configured** - A fully configured visitor and performance analytics dashboard, inclusive of automated reporting templates for designated administrators.
- **User Acceptance Testing Report** - A comprehensive UAT report documenting all test cases, outcomes, issues identified, resolutions applied, and formal client sign-off.
- **Staff Training Sessions** - A minimum of two structured training sessions delivered to administrators, editors, and programme officers, covering day-to-day website management and application processing.
- **Training Manuals and Technical Documentation** - A complete set of supporting documentation, including a CMS user guide, administrator manual, and API documentation.
- **Full Intellectual Property and Source Code Transfer** - Unconditional transfer of all source code, design assets, credentials, and repositories to the client upon project completion.
- **Thirty-Day Post-Launch Support** - A complimentary support period of thirty calendar days following go-live, covering bug fixes and minor enhancements.

2.1 Framework concept for the IT solution

2.1.1 Description of the existing IT solution

Not applicable

2.1.2 Description of the application/use of the IT solution

The IT solution is intended to serve as the primary digital interface for the SME Fund and address the current lack of a centralised, structured, and accessible platform for MSME funding information and application processes.

The solution shall:

- Provide a central platform for communicating programme information, funding instruments, and funding calls
- Enable MSMEs to assess eligibility and submit funding applications online
- Support internal programme processes through structured application workflows and review mechanisms
- Improve efficiency, transparency, and accessibility of funding processes

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Target group:

- Namibian micro, small, and medium enterprises (MSMEs) across sectors
- Programme administrators, evaluators, and stakeholders
- Users with varying levels of digital literacy and access to mobile devices and low-bandwidth internet

The IT solution contributes to:

- Increased MSME access to funding opportunities
- Improved processing and management of applications
- Enhanced data collection and reporting for programme decision-making

2.1.3 General conditions at the partner end (where relevant)

The system will be used and maintained by the SME Fund team and Namibia Investment Promotion and Development Board (NIPDB) implementing partners.

- The solution must be manageable by non-technical staff through an intuitive Content Management System (CMS)
- Training will be required for administrators and programme staff
- The system must be designed to operate within Namibia's varying connectivity conditions
- Provision should be made for knowledge transfer and long-term maintainability

2.1.4 Use of open source software (OSS)

The IT solution should, where appropriate, make use of widely supported and cost-effective technologies, including open-source software options such as WordPress, Drupal, or equivalent CMS platforms.

All solutions must:

- Be product-neutral
- Comply with applicable licensing requirements
- Ensure long-term maintainability and scalability
- Align with the scope of work

2.2 Infrastructure requirements

2.2.1 Deployment environments

The contractor shall implement appropriate deployment environments, including:

- Development environment
- Production (live) environment

These environments must be:

- Clearly separated
- Configured to allow testing prior to deployment

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- Designed to ensure that no live data is used in testing environments

2.2.2 Hosting

The contractor shall provide the following hosting services:

Hosting and domain registration are not part of this assignment.

The contractor shall provide the hosting services in line with the information security requirements set out in Section 7.

2.2.3 Technical security requirements

The IT solution shall comply with standard web security practices, including:

- HTTPS (SSL/TLS encryption) across all pages
- Secure user authentication and access control
- Protection against common web vulnerabilities
- *Secure handling and storage of user and application data*

2.3 Functional requirements

The IT solution must meet the following functional requirements:

- Provide a structured, user-friendly public website presenting programme information, funding instruments, and updates
- Enable the publication and management of funding calls, including filtering and search functionality by sector, region, and funding type
- Include an interactive eligibility self-assessment tool allowing prospective applicants to determine their suitability for funding opportunities
- Provide a secure, multi-step online application system with:
 - Save-and-resume functionality
 - Document upload capability
 - Real-time validation and guidance
 - Submission confirmation with reference number
- Support an internal workflow management system for application processing, including:
 - Multi-stage review processes (e.g. screening, assessment, approval)
 - Role-based access for programme staff and evaluators
 - Reviewer comments, scoring, and decision tracking
- Include an **automated pre-screening and selection functionality**, which:
 - Applies predefined eligibility and scoring criteria to submitted applications
 - Automatically filters and categorises applications (e.g. eligible, ineligible, requires further review)
 - Supports prioritisation or shortlisting of applications based on configurable rules
 - Assists programme staff in decision-making while allowing for manual override
- Provide an applicant user portal/dashboard where users can:
 - Register and manage profiles
 - Track application status
 - Receive notifications and upload additional documents
- Integrate an AI-powered chatbot to assist users with programme-related queries and application guidance

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- Provide automated communication and notification functionalities, including email alerts for application status updates and funding call announcements
- Include a resource centre for downloadable materials, guides, and templates
- Provide an events calendar with event listing and registration functionality
- Include a news and media section for programme updates and communication
- Enable data export (e.g. Excel/CSV) for reporting and administrative purposes

2.4 Non-functional requirements

The IT solution must meet the following non-functional requirements:

- **Usability:**
The system shall provide an intuitive, user-friendly interface for both applicants and administrators, with clear navigation, guidance, and help features.
- **Performance:**
The website shall be optimised for fast loading times and efficient performance, including in low-bandwidth environments. Key pages should load within an acceptable time under normal operating conditions.
- **Scalability:**
The system shall be capable of handling increasing numbers of users, applications, and data volumes without degradation in performance.
- **Security:**
The system shall comply with recognised web security standards, including secure authentication, data encryption (HTTPS), and protection against common vulnerabilities.
- **Compatibility:**
The solution shall be fully functional across major browsers (Chrome, Firefox, Safari, Edge) and accessible on mobile, tablet, and desktop devices.
- **Portability:**
The system shall be responsive and fully operable on mobile devices and varying screen sizes.
- **Accessibility:**
The platform shall be accessible to users with varying levels of digital literacy and should include clear instructions and support features.
- **Operability:**
The system shall function reliably in environments with limited or unstable internet connectivity, reflecting the operational context in Namibia.
- **Maintainability:**
The solution shall allow easy updates and content management through a CMS without requiring advanced technical skills.

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- **Flexibility:**
The system shall allow for future enhancements, including integration with additional tools or systems.
- **Languages:**
The system shall support English as the primary language, with the potential for additional languages if required.
- **Design Compliance:**
The website shall align with SME Fund branding guidelines, ensuring consistency in layout, colours, typography, and overall visual identity.

2.4.1 Interfaces

The IT solution shall support the following interfaces:

- Integration with web analytics tools (e.g. Google Analytics or equivalent) for tracking user behaviour and system performance
- Data export functionality in standard formats (e.g. Excel/CSV) for reporting, monitoring, and administrative purposes
- Potential integration with external systems, including financial management systems or ERP platforms, through APIs or other data exchange mechanisms
- Import and export of data where required, including structured datasets for reporting and analysis
- The system shall be designed to allow future API-based integrations, with appropriate documentation provided

2.4.2 System requirements/technical framework

2.4.3 Sustainability

The IT solution shall be designed with consideration for sustainability and resource efficiency:

- The system shall be optimised to minimise data usage and loading times, particularly for users in low-bandwidth environments
- The solution shall avoid unnecessary system complexity and resource-intensive processes
- Where possible, the system shall utilise efficient hosting configurations and lightweight technologies
- The design shall support long-term use with minimal need for frequent redevelopment or major upgrades
- The contractor shall consider environmentally responsible practices in system design and implementation where feasible

2.5 Further specifications/general conditions

The following general conditions shall apply to the IT solution:

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- **Intellectual Property Rights:**
All intellectual property, including source code, design assets, documentation, and system configurations developed under this contract, shall be transferred in full to the contracting authority upon completion of the assignment.
- **Handover Requirements:**
The contractor shall provide full handover of the system, including all credentials, repositories, and access rights necessary for independent operation and maintenance.
- **Documentation:**
The contractor shall deliver complete and up-to-date technical and user documentation to ensure sustainability and ease of system management.
- **Training and Knowledge Transfer:**
The contractor shall conduct training sessions for designated staff and ensure sufficient knowledge transfer to enable effective system use and administration.
- **Post-Launch Support:**
The contractor shall provide a minimum of thirty (30) days of post-launch support, including bug fixes and minor adjustments at no additional cost.
- **Data Protection and Compliance:**
All data collected, processed, and stored through the system shall comply with applicable data protection regulations and standards.
- **Scalability and Future Use:**
The system shall be designed to allow for future expansion, integration, and enhancement without requiring major redevelopment.
- **Ownership and Access:**
The contracting authority shall retain full administrative control over the system, including unrestricted access to the CMS and all backend functionalities.

3. Responsibilities of the contractor

The contractor will deliver the following services and work packages (along with the corresponding milestones). The work packages have no chronological order and can also be implemented on an integrated basis, depending on the development methodology:

3.1 Work package 1: Kick-off

At the start of the project, the contractor and GIZ clarify the expectations for the cooperation arrangement, the technical platform for cooperation, details of the relevant responsibilities and the project schedule. The first meeting also allows substantive questions to be clarified regarding the issues, defined objectives, requirements and other contextual information.

Services to be rendered by the contractor:

Documentation of the agreements
Establishment of a(n) (online) work environment

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Activities:

- Conduct kick-off meeting with GIZ ProSME, NIPDB and SME Fund and relevant stakeholder
- Clarify project scope, roles, communication channels, and implementation approach
- Establish a project work plan and collaboration environment

Outputs:

- Kick-off meeting documentation
- Agreed project plan and communication structure

3.2 Work package 2: Drafting the implementation concept

The implementation concept is drafted together with the contractor, the target group and any other relevant stakeholders, and includes:

Development methodology, schedule and release plan

- Revised and prioritised functional requirements
- (Provisional) system architecture
- Depending on the methodology: description of the areas of application and system specifications or backlog, for instance with user stories
- Visualisations and outlines (e.g. mock-ups, user journeys, process outlines, ER and use case diagram)

Outcomes to be delivered by the contractor:

Implementation concept

Activities:

- Validate and refine functional and technical requirements with stakeholders
- Develop the implementation concept, including:
 - Development methodology and release plan
 - System architecture and technical approach
 - User journeys, process flows, and system design elements

Outputs:

- Implementation concept document
- Refined and prioritised requirements

3.3 Work package 3: System Development and Integration

The IT solution is to be developed on the basis of the implementation concept. The methodology and the release plan specify the (iterative) publication of functions. The contractor will propose the development methodology and the provisioning model in the technical concept (see Section 9).

Outcomes to be delivered by the contractor:

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Object code and/or operable and executable application

- Documentation of the development process (e.g. implementation progress, changes)
- Annotated source code

Activities:

- Develop the IT solution based on the approved implementation concept
- Configure the CMS and develop all system components
- Integrate required functionalities, including application workflows, dashboards, and third-party tools
- Document development progress and system changes

Outputs:

- Functional system in a staging/testing environment
- Documented development progress and system components

3.4 Work package 4: Testing and quality assurance

The contractor sets up a test environment and, during and after the development process, conducts the relevant recommended tests (e.g. unit tests, integration tests, load tests). Tests are also conducted regularly with future users of the IT solution.

Outcomes to be delivered by the contractor:

Testing concept and test documentation

Documentation of the user feedback and the improvements (faults, weak points, exploits, etc.)

Activities:

- Establish and manage a testing environment
- Conduct functional, integration, and performance testing
- Address system errors, vulnerabilities, and performance issues
- Facilitate user acceptance testing (UAT) with stakeholders

Outputs:

- Test documentation and reports
- Record of identified issues and implemented improvements
- UAT results and confirmation

3.5 Work package 5: Documentation and System Handover Preparation

GIZ must be provided with detailed documentation of the functionalities and the source code annotation in good time and in an appropriate manner. The contractor is obligated to make the latest documentation available for inspection at any time.

If personal data is processed, the contractor will assist GIZ with creating a record of processing activities.

Outcomes to be delivered by the contractor:

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Documentation based on a conventional standard (e.g. arc42)

The documentation must include the following items in particular:

- Software stack and dependencies
- System requirements, system specifications and system architecture
- Diagrams and outlines (e.g. use case, ERD, process outlines, mock-ups)
- Other technical documentation (e.g. interfaces, (clearance of) faults)
- Record of processing activities

3.6 Work package 6: Training.

Activities:

- Conduct training sessions for system administrators and users
- Provide guidance on system use, maintenance, and updates
- Ensure knowledge transfer to enable independent system management

Outputs:

- Training sessions delivered
- Training materials and manuals

3.6.1 Administrative training

The contractor will conduct **1** day/hours of technical training in **Windhoek** for **3** of the **NIPDB** IT personnel. Conducted in English, this training enhances knowledge and capacity for sustainable operations. The training content is also documented in writing.

3.6.2 User training

The contractor will conduct **1** days/hours of training in **Windhoek** for **2** of users of the IT solution content. This training is conducted in **English**. The training content is also documented in writing.

Outcomes to be delivered by the contractor:

Training material
User manual
Administration manual
Guidelines on updating materials and manuals

3.7 Work package 7: Support (and operation)

The contractor provides support for the IT solution until the end of the contractual term. This involves:

- First level support
 - Classifying user enquiries, analysing and resolving frequent, easily rectifiable faults and issues, forwarding to specialists and creating descriptive support tickets
- Second level support

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- Classifying and systematically handling enquiries from first level support, direct phone or written contact with users, updating the knowledge database on frequent problems and issues, forwarding unresolvable problems to third level support
- Third level support
 - Handling enquiries concerning IT administration or operational faults or issues, high degree of specialisation in respective software and hardware, no direct contact with end users

The contractor provides support and operating services until the end of the contractual term. This involves:

- Monitoring and updating the server applications and services
- Monitoring and updating the underlying (web) application, frameworks and other dependencies
- Bug-fixing
- Communicating with the hosting provider in the event of critical incidents

Outcomes to be delivered by the contractor:

- Report on support enquiries that have been addressed
- Report on operational and maintenance activities

3.8 Work package 8: Project management

The contractor appoints an experienced project manager as a permanent contact for the entire term of service provision. The project manager will be responsible for project management on behalf of the contractor.

- Project management involves:
- Compiling an overall picture of GIZ's technical requirements, and breaking them down into a schedule and personnel plan.
- Coordinating the schedule of the individual steps with GIZ and documenting it in the form of a shared project plan.
- The contractor also produces a project/iteration plan that specifies the iteration in which specific requirements are to be implemented.
- During development, regular progress reports must be submitted by the contractor to GIZ.

Outcomes to be delivered by the contractor:

- Project and iteration plan
- Regular progress reports

3.9 Work package 9: Monitoring and reporting

The contractor plays an active role in the results-based monitoring of the project. Regular monitoring activities must cover at least the following areas

Degree to which activities are implemented

Works/services to be put out to tender:**Transaction number:**

Degree to which the objectives, indicators and milestones listed in Section 1.3 of these ToR have been achieved

Results that have occurred in the contractor's sphere of responsibility

Results that have occurred outside the contractor's direct sphere of responsibility:

Risks

Other areas:

- The contractor shall report regularly to GIZ in line with the valid version of the Annex Special Terms and Conditions of Contract for IT services (GIZ).

4. Term, schedule and milestones

The expected term of the contract is 2 months (7 weeks).

The following dates/deadlines apply for achieving the milestones:

Milestones	Delivery date/period (The total duration of the assignment shall not exceed five 5 weeks from the date of contract signing)	Responsible
M1: Project Inception Report and Validated Requirements	Week 1	Contractor
M2: Three (3) Website Design Concepts (wireframes and visual mock-ups)	Week 1	Contractor
M3: Approved Final Design Prototype	Week 2	Contractor
M4: Fully Developed and Operational Website	Week 3	Contractor
M5: AI Chatbot Trained and Deployed	Week 3	Contractor
M6: Online Application System with Workflow Engine	Week 3	Contractor
M7: Analytics Dashboard Configured	Week 4	Contractor
M8: User Acceptance Testing (UAT) Report	Week 5-7	Contractor
M9: Staff Training (minimum 2 sessions)	Week 5	Contractor & NIBPD IT staff
M10: Training Manuals and Technical Documentation	Week 5	Contractor
M11: Full Intellectual Property and Source Code Transfer	Week 5-7	Contractor & NIPDB
M12: Thirty (30) Days Free Post-Launch Support	Commences upon project completion and website launch	Contractor

Works/services to be put out to tender:

Transaction number:

5. Granting rights of use

The contractor grants the rights of use for the IT solution, as per Section 3.1 of the General Terms and Conditions for EVB-IT Service Contracts (EVB-IT-Service-AGB) to both GIZ and to NIPDB.

Following completion of the project, GIZ grants NIPDB the rights of use for the IT solution as per Section 3.2 of the General Terms and Conditions for EVB-IT Service Contracts (EVB-IT-Service-AGB) to NIPDB.

– not applicable –

Sections 3.1 to 3.4 of the EVB-IT-Service do not apply to open source components. GIZ can acquire rights of use for the open source components from the rights holder if it concludes license agreements with the rights holder under the terms and conditions of the relevant open source license(s). In this case the use of the open source components is determined solely by the relevant open source license(s).

The provisions set out in Section 3.1 to 3.4 of the EVB-IT-Service do, however, apply to the software components developed by the contractor, unless these must be licensed as open source software because of obligations arising from an applicable open source license (copyleft effect). The contractor is responsible for checking whether any requirement of this nature applies, and is required to inform GIZ of the outcome. If copyleft requirements apply, and the contractor has informed GIZ of this, the previous paragraph shall apply.

6. Data protection

Particular consideration must be given to aspects of data protection when commissioning IT development work.

7. Information security

The contractor shall deliver the services described in these ToR in accordance with the information security requirements set out in the Information Security Annex (Annex #).

8. Language

In deviation from Sections 1.2., 6.1 and 8.1. of the General Terms and Conditions for EVB-IT Service Contracts, the contractor shall provide the services in English.

9. Technical and methodological concept

In the conceptual design of the tender (technical and methodological approach, project management, if necessary other requirements), the tenderer is required to take specific objectives and requirements into consideration and describe them as explained below.

Works/services to be put out to tender:

Transaction number:

9.1 Requirements for the technical and methodological concept (Section 1 of the assessment grid)

In the tender, the tenderer is required to show *how* the services specified in Section 3 are to be provided, where relevant taking account of other specific methodological requirements (Section 2) (technical and methodological concept).

9.1.1 Assessment of the requirements

The tenderer must assess the objective and the requirements of the IT solution (see Sections 1 and 2) in relation to feasibility and to what particular (non-)technical difficulties must be taken into account in the IT solution to be developed by the tenderer in order to achieve the objective (Section 1.1 of the assessment grid).

9.1.2 Project management and development methodology

The tenderer should consider the design of the project management process and describe their methodology for development/implementation, taking into account the described work packages (Section 3) and compliance with the milestones (Section 4) (Section 1.2 of the assessment grid).

9.1.3 Operational plan/personnel assignment plan

The tenderer must create and explain an operational plan that also includes a personnel assignment plan for all of the specialist staff that they offer. The operational plan must depict the assignment periods (time period and expert days) and, in particular, describe the necessary work steps and take account of and, where necessary, supplement the milestones as per Section 4 (Section 1.3 of the assessment grid).

9.1.4 Test and documentation concept

The tenderer must describe the process for testing and documenting the IT solution and the IT security and documentation standards used (Section 1.4 of the assessment grid).

9.2 Additional requirements (Section 2 of the assessment grid)

10. Human resources

The tenderer is required to propose personnel on the basis of relevant CVs for the positions (as experts) specified and described here in terms of the areas of responsibility and qualifications. **The requirements regarding the format and content of the CVs are set out in Section 12.**

The qualifications set out below reflect the requirements for achieving the maximum number of points in the technical assessment.

‘One year of professional experience’ is understood to mean 12 cumulative expert months with at least 18 expert days per month, provided no diverging definition is specified for individual qualifications.

Works/services to be put out to tender:

Transaction number:

10.1 Expert 1: Team leader (Section 3.1 of the assessment grid)

This position is a key expert. A statement of availability for this expert must be attached to the tender as an annex.

Responsibilities of Expert 1: (Team leader)

- Project and Team Management
- Technical Oversight and Solution Architecture
- Stakeholder Engagement and Project Reporting
- Quality Assurance and Risk Management
- Client Liaison and Relationship Management
- Deployment, Migration, and Go-Live Management
- Maintenance, Support, and Continuous Improvement

Qualifications of Expert 1: (Team leader)

Education/training (Section 2.1.1 of the assessment grid)	University degree (e.g. master's or a German 'Diplom') in Information Technology (IT) or Information and Communication Technology (ICT), complemented by a certification in Project Management
Language (Section 2.1.2 of the assessment grid)	Knowledge of English, C1 in the Common European Framework of Reference for Languages
General professional experience (Section 2.1.3 of the assessment grid)	5 years of professional experience in the area of information Technology, including 2 years of experience leading IT projects or technical teams, and 3 years of experience in the design, development, implementation, or maintenance of web-based systems and digital platforms.
Specific professional experience (Section 2.1.4 of the assessment grid)	2 years of professional experience in leading website, web portal, digital platform development projects.
Leadership/management experience (Section 2.1.5 of the assessment grid)	2 years of management experience in projects, companies or other organisations with disciplinary leadership responsibility for people
Experience in the field of development cooperation (Section 2.1.6 of the assessment grid)	1 years of experience in development cooperation projects
Other (Section 2.1.7 of the assessment grid)	

Works/services to be put out to tender:

Transaction number:

The tenderer must assign all the proposed experts to the required qualifications and clearly present them in a separate table preceding the CVs. The summary presentation must mention only qualifications that are actually indicated in the CVs. Evidence of professional experience must be rendered in the form of meaningful references in the CVs. It is advisable to make specific reference to each instance of professional experience.

Soft skills of team members

In addition to their specialist qualifications, all team members are also expected to have the following qualifications:

- Team players
- Initiative
- Communication skills
- Sociocultural and intercultural skills
- Efficient partner- and client-oriented working methods
- Interdisciplinary thinking

Soft skills will not be evaluated.

11. Costing requirements

11.1 Assignment of experts

In your tender, please do not deviate from the specification of quantities required in these ToR (number of experts and expert days, budget specified in the price schedule). This is part of the competitive tender and is used to ensure that the tenders can be compared objectively. Please note: only services that were commissioned by GIZ and rendered by the contractor will be remunerated. We would also like to point out that it may not be necessary to make use of the total number of proposed expert days.

The number of expert days corresponds to full working days.

Expert	Expert days
Expert 1:	35 days

11.2 Travel expenses

11.2.1 Travel – sustainability considerations

GIZ would like to reduce greenhouse gas emissions (CO₂ emissions) caused by travel. When preparing your tender, please incorporate options for reducing emissions, for example by selecting the lowest-emission booking class (economy) or using means of transport, airlines and flight routes that are more CO₂-efficient. For short distances, travel by train (second class) or e-mobility are the preferred options.

CO₂ emissions resulting from air travel must be offset. GIZ specifies a budget for this which enables carbon offsets can be settled against evidence.

Works/services to be put out to tender:

Transaction number:

There are many different providers in the market for emissions certificates, and they have different climate impact ambitions. The [Development and Climate Alliance](#) has published a [list of standards](#). GIZ recommends using these standards.

11.2.2 Travel expense requirements

Travel expenses must be costed as follows by the contractor:

Travel expense item	Number/quantity/budget
Total number of international flights	N/A
Total number of regional/domestic flights	N/A
Carbon offsets for flights	An unalterable budget for carbon offsets for settlement against evidence is specified.
Transport costs (rail travel, car travel, local public transport)	N/A
Per diem allowances	N/A
Accommodation allowances	N/A
Other travel expenses (visa, project-related travel expenses outside the place of business, etc.)	N/A

Per-diem allowances are reimbursed as a lump sum up to the maximum amounts permissible under tax law for each country as set out in the country table in the circular from the German Federal Ministry of Finance on travel expense reimbursement (download at <https://www.bundesfinanzministerium.de>).

In addition, for the following items, reasonable costs can be settled against evidence up to the proposed amount.

- Flight costs
- Transport costs
- Other travel expenses

Notes on settling accommodation allowances outside Germany.

Accommodation allowances outside Germany that exceed the maximum rate permissible under tax law as set out in the BMF circular, may be reimbursed up to the contractually agreed amount only on the basis of a written justification on a case-by-case basis and where the additional costs were unavoidable (for instance because of the security situation).

All travel must be agreed in advance with the officer responsible for the project. Travel expenses must be kept as low as possible.

Works/services to be put out to tender:

Transaction number:

11.3 Materials and equipment

– not applicable –

11.4 Workshops, training

– not applicable –

11.5 Hosting

– not applicable –

11.6 Other costs

– not applicable –

11.7 Flexible remuneration

– not applicable –

12. Requirements on the format of the tender

The structure of the tender must correspond to the structure of the ToR. It must be legible (font size 11 or larger) and clearly formulated. The technical bid must be submitted in English.

The technical and methodological concept of the tender (Section 9 of the ToR) is not to exceed 10 pages (not including the cover page, list of abbreviations, table of contents and brief introduction). Additional annexes not requested will not be assessed. External content (e.g. links to websites) will also not be considered.

The CVs of the staff proposed in accordance with Section 0 of the ToR must be in the EU format and not more than four (4) pages in length. The CVs must clearly show what position the proposed person held, which tasks they performed and how many expert days they worked during which period in the specified references. The CVs can also be submitted in English.

We strongly request that you do not exceed the number of pages specified.

The CVs must clearly and unequivocally show what position the proposed person held, which tasks they performed and how long they worked during which period in the specified references. **The references contained in the CVs must therefore include the following information:**

- Name of the company/organisation/reference project in which the expert worked
- Position held and task(s) performed by the expert in the company/organisation/reference project
- Work outcomes or products produced by the expert, or expert's contribution to the completion of these outcomes and projects (if relevant)
- Duration of the expert's assignment in the company/organisation/reference project per calendar year in full-time expert days, weeks or months (for example: 2019: 2 months, 2020: 10 months, 2021: 1 month)
- Leadership experience/management: clear information on the reference projects or fixed positions within the company/organisation in which the requirements specified in

Works/services to be put out to tender:

Transaction number:

Section 0 were fulfilled (for example, period, number of persons for whom the expert had disciplinary responsibility, project budget) (if relevant)

- International professional experience/professional experience in the country of assignment: clear information on the reference projects or fixed positions in the company/organisation in which the requirements specified in Section 0 were fulfilled (for example, actual duration of assignment on the ground in full-time expert days, weeks or months) (if relevant)

In order to facilitate the assessment, we request that you number the references consecutively and provide only references that are clearly related to the object of this tender.

13. Options or follow-on contract

13.1 Option to extend services to be delivered/service delivery period in accordance with Section 132 (2) 1 of the German Act against Restraints of Competition (GWB)

– not applicable –

13.2 Follow-on contract in accordance with Section 14 (4) 9 of the German Ordinance on the Award of Public Contracts (VgV)

– not applicable –

14. Annexes (optional)

– not applicable –